Faysah Racman Pimping Maniri Dumarpa

Faysah Racman Pimping Maniri Dumarpa (born March 1952) is a Filipina educator, social servant, and politician from Marawi City, Lanao del Sur. She spent the better part of two decades in public service, first as a regional legislator in the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM), then as a three-term member of the House of Representatives representing Lanao del Sur's 1st District from 2001 to 2010.<ref name="geni">Template:Cite web</ref> She's remembered as one of the more prominent Moro women to hold national office, and her legislative record leans heavily toward carving out space for Islamic identity within Philippine law, strengthening social services, and staying involved in the peace process between the government and the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF).

She's the mother of Atty. Faydah Maniri Racman-Pimping Dumarpa, who currently serves as a Commissioner at the Commission on Human Rights (CHR), appointed by President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. in December 2022.<ref name="chr">Template:Cite web</ref>

Contents

1 EARLY LIFE AND FAMILY BACKGROUND
2 EDUCATION
3 EARLY PUBLIC SERVICE AND REGIONAL CAREER
4 CONGRESSIONAL CAREER (2001 TO 2010)
5 INSTITUTIONAL AND LEGISLATIVE CONTRIBUTIONS
5.1 TECHNICAL LEGISLATIVE OVERVIEW
6 MARAWI SIEGE REHABILITATION ADVOCACY
7 AWARDS AND RECOGNITION
8 SEE ALSO

EARLY LIFE AND FAMILY BACKGROUND

Faysah grew up in Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, immersed in traditional Meranao culture from childhood. That grounding in Meranao custom and community life later became the backbone of her academic and political career, shaping how she approached sociology, anthropology, and eventually, legislation touching on Bangsamoro identity.

Faysah Racman Pimping Maniri Dumarpa



Born

March 1952, Marawi City, Lanao del Sur

Occupation

Educator, social servant, legislator

Years Active

1993 to 2010 (public office)

Political Party

Represented Lanao del Sur's 1st District, House of Representatives (2001 to 2010)

Spouse

Atty. Salic Biston Dumarpa

Children

Atty. Faydah Maniri Racman-Pimping Dumarpa

Alma Mater

Pangarungan Islamic College (BS Education); Centro Escolar University (MA Anthropology)

Notability

Her husband, Atty. Salic Biston Dumarpa, worked as a human rights lawyer and later served as a Commissioner of the National Labor Relations Commission (NLRC). Their daughter, Atty. Faydah Maniri Racman-Pimping Dumarpa, has carried the family's tradition of public service forward through her own work at the CHR.

Three-term Representative of Lanao del Sur's 1st District who authored the law making Eid'l Adha a national holiday

Known For

Championing Islamic identity in national law, Moro women's political representation, and post-Marawi Siege advocacy

EDUCATION

Faysah built her academic foundation around teaching first, then broadened into cultural studies later in her career.

She earned her Bachelor of Science in Education at Pangarungan Islamic College in Marawi City, the degree that set her on the path toward classroom teaching. She went on to complete a Master of Arts in Anthropology at Centro Escolar University in Manila, a credential that gave her the analytical tools to connect national policymaking with Moro cultural systems and representation.

EARLY PUBLIC SERVICE AND REGIONAL CAREER

Long before she reached national office, Faysah built her career around education and social welfare work across Mindanao.

She started out as a classroom instructor at Pangarungan Islamic College, teaching in the same institution where she'd earned her own degree. From there, she moved into government service as an Undersecretary at the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) under the ARMM, where she oversaw relief operations for communities caught in the crossfire of armed conflict.

In 1993, she stepped into elected office for the first time as a Regional Legislative Assemblywoman, representing Lanao del Sur in the 3rd ARMM Regional Legislative Assembly, a position she held until 2001.<ref name="geni" /> That stretch in regional government marked her real entry into policymaking.

Her profile grew from there. She served as a peace negotiator, reportedly the only woman on the government's peace panel engaging the MILF, and was later tapped by President Gloria Macapagal Arroyo to sit on the 2005 Constitutional Commission as a charter consultant.

CONGRESSIONAL CAREER (2001 TO 2010)

Faysah won her seat in the House of Representatives in 2001 and went on to serve three consecutive terms representing Lanao del Sur's 1st District, stepping down in 2010 after completing the maximum number of terms allowed.<ref name="geni" /> During her time in Congress, she chaired the Committee on Social Services and served as Vice-Chairperson of the Committee on Muslim Affairs.

INSTITUTIONAL AND LEGISLATIVE CONTRIBUTIONS

Her legislative work centered on three things: giving Islamic identity a rightful place in national law, protecting minorities from discrimination, and building infrastructure for her district back home.

She authored Republic Act No. 9849, the law that declared the tenth day of Zhul Hijja, the twelfth month of the Islamic calendar, a nationwide holiday for the observance of Eid'l Adha.<ref name="ra9849">Template:Cite web</ref><ref name="ra9849author">Template:Cite web</ref> Signed into law on December 11, 2009, the measure embedded one of Islam's two major feast days into the national holiday calendar, applied nationwide and not just in Muslim-majority areas.

She also pushed for the expansion of Shari'ah court funding and jurisdiction across Mindanao, and championed anti-profiling measures aimed at protecting Muslim Filipinos and indigenous groups from religious and racial profiling.

On the education front, she authored Republic Act No. 9921, which converted the RPMD National High School in Barangay Papandayan Caniogan, City of Marawi, into the RPMD National Science High School, opening up dedicated STEM education access for Moro youth in Lanao del Sur.<ref name="ra9921">Template:Cite web</ref> <ref name="ra9921author">Template:Cite web</ref>

TECHNICAL LEGISLATIVE OVERVIEW

Measure	What It Did	Impact
Republic Act No. 9849	Declared Eid'l Adha a nationwide holiday	Mainstreamed Islamic observance into the national calendar
Republic Act No. 9921	Created RPMD National Science High School	Built state-backed STEM education access for Moro youth
House Bill No. 4832	Deferred regional polls to align with national election cycles	Helped stabilize institutions during peace negotiations

MARAWI SIEGE REHABILITATION ADVOCACY

Faysah stayed active in civic life well after leaving Congress. Following the 2017 Marawi Siege, she stood with displaced Meranao families, pressing Task Force Bangon Marawi to return ancestral lands to their rightful owners and pushing back against commercial development plans for what became known as the "Ground Zero" area of the city.

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Her decades of work earned her recognition on multiple fronts:

- ASEAN Gintong Ina Award
- Sultan Kudarat Award for Most Outstanding Muslim Educator
- Bangsamoro Woman of Distinction Award

SEE ALSO

- List of members of the House of Representatives of the Philippines
- Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- 2017 Marawi siege
- Eid al-Adha

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